Hamas, although autonomous, depends for its struggle against Israel on the aid of the religious Shiite regime of Iran and its fanatical stance against the "Zionist entity." Thus, the religious dimension is playing an important role in the politics of Netanyahu's extremist coalition, and even more so in the uncompromising militancy of Hamas, Hezbollah, and their patron, Iran. This doesn't exclude political calculations on both sides.

Wednesday, November 1

The Yemeni Houthis have declared war on Israel. Yesterday, Israel bombed the Jabalia refugee camp in an attempt to kill a senior Hamas leader hiding there, killing dozens of civilians in the process. Foreign nationals are leaving the enclave. Jordan has recalled its ambassador from Israel.

The enormous upsurge of anti-Israeli sentiment in Western countries is astonishing. The horror of the attack by Hamas did not create any significant change of opinion; the war that it triggered merely accelerated the anti-Israeli and antisemitic surge.

How long can this go on is anybody's guess. Israel will be able to withstand the tsunami of international hostility as long as the United States is backing its progress in Gaza—notwithstanding the growing number of civilian casualties it entails. But how long can we rely on America's stand? And do not mistake the situation on the home front: the Israeli population has no confidence in its leadership, to say the least. This also reminds us of the two Lebanon wars, but it is worse. For the time being, anger motivates Israel, an understandable anger. President Biden understands it, as do other Americans.

Yesterday, Secretary of State Blinken spoke at a Senate hearing to remind us all of the starting point of this war: the October 7 Hamas aggression, which led to the killing—and often the torture—of 1,400 Israelis and the taking of 240 hostages at the last estimate.